SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

11 September 2023 · Shift 2

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 42 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 2 questions

Q.8

₹8,000 becomes ₹9,800 in three years at simple interest rate. If the rate of interest becomes two times of itself, then what will be the amount of the same principle in four years?

(A) ₹10,800
(B) ₹11,800
(C) ₹12,800
(D) ₹13,500

Q.14

By investing ₹12,000 in a scheme, R gets ₹15,500 back in return. What is his percentage of profit?

(A) 27.19%
(B) 29.17%
(C) 17.92%
(D) 19.17%

General Awareness 21 questions

Q.1

Who propounded the concept of ‘Rule of Law’?

(A) AV Dicey
(B) CK Daphtary
(C) Austin
(D) AK Sen

Q.2

In which state is Vijay Stambh situated?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Punjab
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Gujarat

Q.3

Which state passed a bill for the protection of advocates and became the first state to do so?

(A) Punjab
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Haryana
(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.4

Chaoite, Buckminsterfullerene and Graphene are related to which element?

(A) Arsenic
(B) Carbon
(C) Sulphur
(D) Bromine

Q.5

Who is credited with the establishment of Servants of India Society?

(A) Lala Lajpat Rai
(B) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(C) MG Ranade
(D) CR Das

Q.6
The value of all final goods and services produced within the country during one year is known as _____.

(A) gross national product
(B) net national product
(C) gross domestic product
(D) net domestic product

Q.7
Who was the first speaker of the Lok Sabha?

(A) NS Reddy
(B) GV Mavalankar
(C) Ananthasayanam Ayyangar
(D) Mira Kumar

Q.10
The technique of classical dancing was codified by _____ in about the 5th century B.C.

(A) Sudraka
(B) Bharata
(C) Chanakya
(D) Kalhana

Q.11
Who among the following is the author of the novel 'Animal Farm'?

(A) Thomas Hardy
(B) George Orwell
(C) Roald Dahl
(D) Charles Dickens

Q.13
According to the Census of India 2011, which of the following states has the lowest population?

(A) Sikkim
(B) Goa
(C) Manipur
(D) Mizoram

Q.15
In which of the following years was the Child Marriage Restraint Act passed?

(A) 1856
(B) 1947
(C) 1878
(D) 1929

Q.16
What is the main reason behind the substantial rainfall during summer on the western coasts of India?

(A) Western Ghats
(B) Eastern winds
(C) Indus River
(D) Eastern Ghats

Q.17
The second edition of Khelo India Youth Games, 2019 was organised in which city?

(A) Pune
(B) Guwahati
(C) New Delhi
(D) Mumbai

Q.18
ACF conferred Grandmaster _____ with Player of the Year award, who is only the sixth Indian to break the 2700 Elo-rating mark and the youngest Grandmaster from the country to be rated above 2700.

(A) NR Vignesh
(B) Aadit Khan
(C) Koshy Varugeese
(D) D Gukesh

Q.19
Which condition causes bone pain, poor growth, and soft, weak bones that can lead to bone deformities?

(A) Rickets
(B) Cerebral Palsy
(C) Pertussis
(D) Asplenia

Q.20
In which Indian musician's name did the state of Massachusetts in the USA declare April 20th in 1984 as a day in his name?

(A) Brij Narayan
(B) Ali Akbar Khan
(C) Rajeev Taranath
(D) Amjad Ali Khan

Q.21
Which of the following is an advantage of microfinance institutions in India?

(A) Limited impact on poverty reduction
(B) Increased reliance on informal lending sources
(C) Minimal support for women entrepreneurs
(D) Enhanced financial inclusion

Q.22
Which of the following statements about Mahatma Gandhi is INCORRECT?

(A) Mahatma Gandhi was born in 1869 in Porbandar.
(B) In 1942, he launched the Quit India Movement.
(C) He led the Champaran Satyagraha in 1910.
(D) He led the Dandi Salt March in 1930.

Q.23
Which university won the first place in the 3rd Khelo India University Games?

(A) University of Mumbai
(B) Panjab University
(C) Shivaji University
(D) University of Madras

Q.24
In which of the following states of India is the maximum extent of alluvial soil found?

(A) Telangana
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Karnataka
(D) Maharashtra

Q.25
The _____ port was developed after Independence to ease the volume of trade on the Mumbai port.

(A) Kandla
(B) Kolkata
(C) Chennai
(D) Visakhapatnam

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Curiousity
(B) Vehemence
(C) Superficial
(D) Synagogue

Q.2
Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. Riddhi believes in "wearing her heart on her sleeve". That is why she has so many friends.

(A) To criticise everybody
(B) To wear a badge of honour
(C) To openly and freely express one's emotions
(D) To talk aloud

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To cross swords

(A) To kill
(B) To arrange
(C) To fight
(D) To defend

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Virtual worlds are recently new phenomena in that they _____ people to meet and socially interact with others in a variety of online environments.

(A) forbid
(B) bring
(C) choose
(D) enable

Q.5

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error. I have seen / a movie / on schooling / yesterday.

(A) I have seen
(B) on schooling
(C) yesterday
(D) a movie

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Cheap

(A) Expensive
(B) Ignorant
(C) Old
(D) Untangle

Q.7

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Kavya invited all her friends, “isn’t it?”

(A) didn’t she?
(B) did she?
(C) don’t she?
(D) isn’t she?

Q.8

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. The deal was _____ for three months.

(A) cut no ice
(B) broken the ice
(C) tipped of the iceberg
(D) put on ice

Q.9

The given sentence contains an error. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. This is the eldest standing structure of Chola architecture in India.

(A) This is the more older standing structure of Chola architecture in India.
(B) This is the most old standing structure of Chola architecture in India.
(C) This is the more elder standing structure of Chola architecture in India.
(D) This is the oldest standing structure of Chola architecture in India.

Q.10

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. They decided to / travel in train / instead of driving / to New Delhi.

(A) They decided to
(B) travel in train
(C) to New Delhi
(D) instead of driving

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Strengthen

(A) Debilitate
(B) Strain
(C) Fortify
(D) Ascend

Q.12

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Fame

(A) Name
(B) Shame
(C) Scandal
(D) Stingy

Q.13

Select the sentence that has NO spelling errors.

(A) My new phone has a high-resolusion screen and powerful proccessor, which makes it perfect for streming videos and playing games.

(B) My new phone has a high-resollution screen and a powerfull procesor, which makes it perfect for streaming videos and playing games.

(C) My new phone has a high-resolution screen and a powerful processor, which makes it perfect for streaming videos and playing games.

(D) My new phone has a high-resolution screan and powerfull procesor, which makes it perfect for streming videos and playing games.

Q.14

Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the following sentence. Being a doktor, my sister Meera is prepared for an emergency usually.

(A) prepared
(B) doktor
(C) usually
(D) emergency

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. I suppose dancing that well would require a lot of “actual application”.

(A) prevention
(B) perseverance
(C) practice
(D) perception

Q.16

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. A music / is a great way / to express / your emotions.

(A) to express
(B) is a great way
(C) A music
(D) your emotions

Q.17

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. You are an intellectual with a professional degree; you can do wonders as _____.

(A) you are playing with fire
(B) you can say it again
(C) your mileage may vary
(D) the world is your oyster

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Rashmi works at the hospital, “don’t she?”

(A) does she?
(B) has she?
(C) doesn’t she?
(D) do she?

Q.19

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Radha will have learnt cooking by the time she will have married.

(A) learnt cooking
(B) by the time
(C) she will have married
(D) Radha will have

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Fear of closed spaces

(A) Xenophobia
(B) Claustrophobia
(C) Hydrophobia
(D) Zoophobia

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A cashless India is the first step towards making the dream of digital India a reality. Government is trying to (1)_____ a cashless environment in the country. Demonetisation appears to be a stepping (2)_____ in that direction. To help facilitate this, government even (3)_____ its own app 'BHIM' built for the same purpose. The (4)_____ of conducting online financial transactions is probably the biggest motivator to go digital. You will no longer need to carry wads of cash, plastic cards or even queue up for ATM withdrawals. It's also safer and easier spending option when you are travelling. Making transactions digitally makes it easy to keep track of your finances. The (5)_____ are enormous for everyone if you leave out the low-income group, which will face a huge challenge. For the rest of the country, it is constructive and simple. However, the convenience of net-banking, m-banking, card or mobile wallet transactions can make you spend more than your budget.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 1.

(A) preach
(B) determine
(C) precede
(D) create

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A cashless India is the first step towards making the dream of digital India a reality. Government is trying to (1)_____ a cashless environment in the country. Demonetisation appears to be a stepping (2)_____ in that direction. To help facilitate this, government even (3)_____ its own app 'BHIM' built for the same purpose. The (4)_____ of conducting online financial transactions is probably the biggest motivator to go digital. You will no longer need to carry wads of cash, plastic cards or even queue up for ATM withdrawals. It's also safer and easier spending option when you are travelling. Making transactions digitally makes it easy to keep track of your finances. The (5)_____ are enormous for everyone if you leave out the low-income group, which will face a huge challenge. For the rest of the country, it is constructive and simple. However, the convenience of net-banking, m-banking, card or mobile wallet transactions can make you spend more than your budget.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 2.

(A) method
(B) matter
(C) stairs
(D) stone

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A cashless India is the first step towards making the dream of digital India a reality. Government is trying to (1)_____ a cashless environment in the country. Demonetisation appears to be a stepping (2)_____ in that direction. To help facilitate this, government even (3)_____ its own app 'BHIM' built for the same purpose. The (4)_____ of conducting online financial transactions is probably the biggest motivator to go digital. You will no longer need to carry wads of cash, plastic cards or even queue up for ATM withdrawals. It's also safer and easier spending option when you are travelling. Making transactions digitally makes it easy to keep track of your finances. The (5)_____ are enormous for everyone if you leave out the low-income group, which will face a huge challenge. For the rest of the country, it is constructive and simple. However, the convenience of net-banking, m-banking, card or mobile wallet transactions can make you spend more than your budget.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 3.

(A) followed
(B) sensed
(C) launched
(D) submitted

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A cashless India is the first step towards making the dream of digital India a reality. Government is trying to (1)_____ a cashless environment in the country. Demonetisation appears to be a stepping (2)_____ in that direction. To help facilitate this, government even (3)_____ its own app 'BHIM' built for the same purpose. The (4)_____ of conducting online financial transactions is probably the biggest motivator to go digital. You will no longer need to carry wads of cash, plastic cards or even queue up for ATM withdrawals. It's also safer and easier spending option when you are travelling. Making transactions digitally makes it easy to keep track of your finances. The (5)_____ are enormous for everyone if you leave out the low-income group, which will face a huge challenge. For the rest of the country, it is constructive and simple. However, the convenience of net-banking, m-banking, card or mobile wallet transactions can make you spend more than your budget.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 4.

(A) hassle
(B) ease
(C) agony
(D) delay

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. A cashless India is the first step towards making the dream of digital India a reality. Government is trying to (1)_____ a cashless environment in the country. Demonetisation appears to be a stepping (2)_____ in that direction. To help facilitate this, government even (3)_____ its own app 'BHIM' built for the same purpose. The (4)_____ of conducting online financial transactions is probably the biggest motivator to go digital. You will no longer need to carry wads of cash, plastic cards or even queue up for ATM withdrawals. It's also safer and easier spending option when you are travelling. Making transactions digitally makes it easy to keep track of your finances. The (5)_____ are enormous for everyone if you leave out the low-income group, which will face a huge challenge. For the rest of the country, it is constructive and simple. However, the convenience of net-banking, m-banking, card or mobile wallet transactions can make you spend more than your budget.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 5.

(A) attempts
(B) scenarios
(C) benefits
(D) severity

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.8 **(C)** Q.14 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**
Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**			

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.8 · Answer (C) ₹12,800

SI = 9,800 − 8,000 = ₹1,800 in 3 years, so the rate is 1,800 × 100/(8,000 × 3) = 7.5%. At twice that, 15%, for 4 years: SI = 8,000 × 15 × 4/100 = ₹4,800 and the amount is ₹12,800.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 29.17%

Profit = 15,500 − 12,000 = ₹3,500, and 3,500/12,000 × 100 ≈ 29.17%.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) AV Dicey

A. V. Dicey set out the 'rule of law' in 'Introduction to the Study of the Law of the Constitution' (1885): no one is above the law, and everyone is subject to the ordinary courts.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Rajasthan

The Vijay Stambh (Tower of Victory) in Chittorgarh Fort, Rajasthan, was built by Rana Kumbha of Mewar in the 15th century to mark his victory over Mahmud Khalji of Malwa.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Rajasthan

The Rajasthan Assembly passed the Rajasthan Advocates Protection Bill in March 2023, making Rajasthan the first state to pass such a measure, to protect lawyers from assault and intimidation linked to their work.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Carbon

Chaoite, buckminsterfullerene (C_{60}) and graphene are allotropes of carbon, as are diamond and graphite.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Gopal Krishna Gokhale

Gopal Krishna Gokhale founded the Servants of India Society in Pune in 1905 to train Indians for the service of the country.

Q.6 · Answer (C) gross domestic product

GDP is the value of all final goods and services produced within a country's territory in a year. GNP adds net factor income from abroad, and the 'net' measures deduct depreciation.

Q.7 · Answer (B) GV Mavalankar

G. V. Mavalankar was the first Speaker of the Lok Sabha, from 1952 to 1956; M. Ananthasayanam Ayyangar, its first Deputy Speaker, succeeded him.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Bharata

Bharata Muni's Natyashastra, the oldest surviving Indian treatise on drama, dance and music, set down the technique of classical dance.

Q.11 · Answer (B) George Orwell

'Animal Farm' (1945), a political fable about a revolution among farm animals, is by George Orwell.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Sikkim

Sikkim, with about 6.1 lakh people, was the least populous state in the 2011 Census; Mizoram, Goa and Manipur each had more than 10 lakh.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 1929

The Child Marriage Restraint Act, 1929, called the Sarda Act after Harbilas Sarda, who moved it, fixed the minimum age of marriage at 14 for girls and 18 for boys.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Western Ghats

The moist southwest monsoon winds from the Arabian Sea are forced to rise over the Western Ghats, where they cool and shed heavy orographic rain on the windward western coast.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Pune
The second Khelo India Youth Games were held in Pune, Maharashtra, in January 2019; the first edition, held in New Delhi in 2018, was called the Khelo India School Games.

Q.18 · Answer (D) D Gukesh
D. Gukesh, who crossed 2700 Elo in 2022, received the Asian Chess Federation's Player of the Year award in March 2023 for his 2022 season.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Rickets
Rickets, usually caused by a lack of vitamin D (or of calcium or phosphate) in childhood, softens and weakens growing bones, leading to pain, poor growth and deformities such as bowed legs.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Amjad Ali Khan
In 1984 the US state of Massachusetts proclaimed 20 April Amjad Ali Khan Day in honour of the sarod maestro.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Enhanced financial inclusion
Microfinance institutions give small loans and other financial services to low-income households, many of them led by women, who have little access to banks, so they widen financial inclusion. The other options are drawbacks, not advantages.

Q.22 · Answer (C) He led the Champaran Satyagraha in 1910.
Gandhi led the Champaran Satyagraha, his first in India, in 1917, not 1910; in 1910 he was still in South Africa. The other three statements are correct.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Panjab University
Panjab University, Chandigarh, was the overall champion of the third Khelo India University Games, held in Uttar Pradesh in May-June 2023.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Uttar Pradesh
Alluvial soil covers the whole Ganga plain, so Uttar Pradesh has by far the largest extent of it among the options; Telangana, Karnataka and Maharashtra lie mostly on the Deccan, with black and red soils.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Kandla
Kandla, in Kachchh, Gujarat, was the first port developed after Independence, to ease the load on Mumbai after Karachi went to Pakistan at Partition. It has since been renamed Deendayal Port.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) Curiousity
The correct spelling is 'curiosity', without the 'u' of 'curious'.

Q.2 · Answer (C) To openly and freely express one’s emotions
To 'wear one's heart on one's sleeve' is to show one's feelings openly.

Q.3 · Answer (C) To fight
To 'cross swords' with someone is to fight or argue with them.

Q.4 · Answer (D) enable
To 'enable' people to meet is to make it possible for them, which is what online virtual worlds do; 'forbid' says the opposite, and 'bring' and 'choose' do not give this sense.

Q.5 · Answer (A) I have seen
'Yesterday' names a finished past time, which takes the simple past, not the present perfect: 'I saw a movie on schooling yesterday.'

Q.6 · Answer (A) Expensive
'Cheap' means low in price; its opposite is 'expensive'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) didn’t she?
A positive statement in the simple past takes a negative tag with 'did' and the subject's pronoun: 'Kavya invited all her friends, didn't she?'

Q.8 · Answer (D) put on ice
To 'put something on ice' is to postpone or suspend it: the deal was put on hold for three months.

Q.9 · Answer (D) This is the oldest standing structure of Chola architecture in India.
'Eldest' is used only of people, mainly within a family; for a building the superlative is 'oldest'. 'More older', 'most old' and 'more elder' are wrong forms.

Q.10 · Answer (B) travel in train
A means of transport takes 'by' without an article: 'travel by train'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Debilitate
To 'strengthen' is to make stronger; to 'debilitate' is to weaken. 'Fortify' is a synonym.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Shame
SSC's key gives 'shame', disgrace, as the opposite of 'fame', a good name and renown. 'Scandal' also suggests disgrace, but it names the event or talk that causes it, so 'shame' is the closer opposite.

Q.13 · Answer (C) My new phone has a high-resolution screen and a powerful processor, which makes it perfect for streaming videos and playing games.
Only this sentence spells every word correctly; the others misspell 'resolution', 'screen', 'powerful', 'processor' or 'streaming'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) doktor
The correct spelling is 'doctor'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) practice
'Practice' is the actual doing or application of something, as against theory, and the repeated exercise that builds skill.

Q.16 · Answer (C) A music
'Music' is an uncountable noun and takes no 'a': 'Music is a great way to express your emotions.'

Q.17 · Answer (D) the world is your oyster
'The world is your oyster' means you are free and able to achieve whatever you want, which fits a gifted person with a professional degree.

Q.18 · Answer (C) doesn’t she?
A positive statement in the simple present with a singular subject takes 'doesn't' in the tag: 'Rashmi works at the hospital, doesn't she?'

Q.19 · Answer (C) she will have married
A time clause with 'by the time' takes the simple present for a future event, not 'will': 'by the time she gets married'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Claustrophobia
'Claustrophobia' is the fear of closed spaces; xenophobia is fear of foreigners, hydrophobia of water and zoophobia of animals.

Q.21 · Answer (D) create
The government is trying to 'create', bring into being, a cashless environment.

Q.22 · Answer (D) stone
A 'stepping stone' is a step towards a goal: demonetisation as a stepping stone towards a cashless India.

Q.23 · Answer (C) launched
To 'launch' an app is to bring it out: the government launched its own app, BHIM.

Q.24 · Answer (B) ease

The 'ease' of online transactions, how easy they are, is what motivates people to go digital; 'hassle', 'agony' and 'delay' would put them off.

Q.25 · Answer (C) benefits

The 'benefits', the advantages the passage lists, are enormous for everyone except the low-income group.

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